

John 7: Jesus at the Feast of Tabernacles

1-24: Going up to the feast

- What shift in tone do you see between the end of Chapter 6 and the beginning of chapter 7?
 - **He came to his own (1:1)... No more to Jerusalem except for the feasts**
- Why did his brothers urge him to go up to the feast?
 - **They didn't believe in him. (But see Acts 1:14)**
- What do you make of Jesus going up despite saying he would not?
 - **Not publicly**
 - **Not yet**
- How is Jesus's authority represented in this passage?
 - **Rabbinic principle: The one sent is received with the authority of the sender.**
 - **He seeks and shares the glory of the Father (see Ch 1: Jesus is the one and only God who reveals the glory of the Father)**
- The feast of Tabernacles forms the background of this passage
 - **Harvest (Thanksgiving) Deut 16:13-15**
 - **Messianic feast (Zech 14:1ff). Gentiles will keep it in Jerusalem**
 - **Bar Kochba (pretended Messiah) coins: sheaves of Tabernacles**

25-36: The reaction of the crowd

- What ideas do they have about Jesus and why?
 - **Confused and contradictory statements**

- **Seemingly ignorant of important Scripture passages**
- What do they get wrong about where he comes from?
 - **They knew what city he came from, but the important point is that he came from the Father**
 - **John's distinctive treatment of faith.**

37-52: Rivers of flowing water

- Jesus's loud declaration and the meaning of the feast?
 - **Water represents the expected eschatological Spirit**
 - **Water flows from Temple, rock, and the lamb in Scripture**
 - **Amid the ritual pouring of water, Jesus says come to *ME!***
- Does the water come from Jesus or from those who believe in him?
 - **Chiastic structure indicates proper translation:**
 - **If anyone thirsts ... let him come to me**
and
 - **Let him drink ... he who believes in me**
- What confusion do you see in the people's thoughts about Jesus?
 - **He really is the Prophet**
 - **No, the Messiah must come from Bethlehem (but he did)**
- What do you make of the reaction of the temple officers?
 - **No one ever spoke like him**
 - **The prophets said "Come to God". Jesus said "Come to *me*"**
- What is the stance of the Sanhedrin authorities?
 - **"No prophet comes from Galilee. Look into it"**
 - **They completely miss Isaiah 9:1 (quoted in Mt 4)**

**→ From Galilee...unto us a son is given... the government of
the world will be on his shoulders... almighty God...
everlasting Father... prince of peace**